MERIDIAN HARBOR LOGISTICS

Office of Information Technology · Assessment Engagement Packet
To: Northstar Security Assurance, Technical Assessment Team
Reference: MHL-NSA-100 · Revision 0.1 · Draft pending environment acceptance

Letter of engagement

Meridian Harbor Logistics requests an assessment of the technology supporting our dispatch, customer shipment tracking, finance reporting, and recently acquired warehouse operation. Our next major customer requires assurance that customer records and internal business systems are appropriately protected.

Please assess the environment as a connected business. We need clear evidence of business impact, practical recommendations, and a prioritized remediation plan that a small IT team can carry out. A list of scanner findings alone will not meet our objectives.

Company context

We coordinate regional freight and temperature-controlled deliveries. Dispatch staff rely on Windows domain accounts and shared documents; customers use a Linux-hosted shipment portal. Warehouse deployment and backup tooling was retained after an acquisition because replacing it would disrupt operations. Integration was performed under a tight schedule and documentation is uneven.

Points of contact

Contact	Responsibility	Contact channel
Evelyn Vale, Director of Technology	Executive sponsor and scope decisions	security@meridianharbor.example
Jonas Reed, Infrastructure Lead	Windows/domain and server operations	operations@meridianharbor.example
Mira Chen, Service Desk Lead	Assessment coordination and incident escalation	servicedesk@meridianharbor.example

The organizer-provided engagement channel is the operational channel during the assessment. These company contacts are fictional scenario identities.

Authorized environment

Each assessment team receives a separate company environment. Its assigned system addresses, custom subnets, credentials and engagement window will be provided in the final environment schedule. The Windows domain is `mhl.test`. Only that team's listed company targets are in scope. The overall Project 100 aggregate is `10.100.0.0/16`; it is not permission to access another team's systems or assessment workstations.

Expected company systems are MHL-DC01, MHL-FS01, MHL-DB01, MHL-APP01, MHL-CI01 and MHL-BKP01. Assessors receive personal Linux and Windows workstations through the designated remote-access portal. Access to a workstation does not confer authorization over the portal or its underlying infrastructure.

Rules of engagement

- Assess only the assigned targets and supplied application URLs/accounts.
- Use controlled proofs of concept and synthetic records to demonstrate impact; explain the attack conditions and resulting business risk.
- Preserve service availability and evidence. Coordinate before disruptive changes, account lockouts, bulk data changes, or persistence testing.
- Stop and report access to an unexpected environment or another team's data.
- Exclude denial of service, destructive encryption, uncontrolled malware, social engineering of real people, and attacks on public Internet systems.
- Hypervisors, storage infrastructure, the range controller, Guacamole, shared firewall, underlying management networks and other teams are out of scope. Do not attempt to escape a guest or compromise these systems.

Requested deliverables

1. An executive summary describing material business risks.
2. A technical report with affected assets, reproducible evidence, realistic impact, severity rationale, and remediation.
3. A connected attack narrative where findings combine into greater impact.
4. A prioritized remediation roadmap, separating immediate containment from longer-term improvements.
5. A short technical handoff and executive briefing.

Use screenshots and minimal proof-of-concept artifacts where useful. Keep credentials out of general report copies and submit sensitive material through the organizer's designated channel. Include assumptions, limitations, and unverified findings explicitly.

Simulation notice: Meridian Harbor Logistics and Northstar Security Assurance are fictional. All business data is synthetic. This draft does not claim that the laboratory has been deployed or accepted; the final target schedule and engagement window are issued after technical acceptance.